

WEEK 1 OF 4 · Body

Script 1: Scanning the Armor**Theme: Body Awareness and Proprioception**

Rationale: A general body scan to identify and release held tension. As martial artists, we must know where every part of the body is to be effective.

Request that students line up in a horse-stance or sit on their knees. If someone has a physical disability, have them find a comfortable seated upright position. Remind students of the "out."

"Today we are moving our focus from the breath to the body. As martial artists, we must know where every part of our body is to be effective. Take a moment to settle into your meditation stance. Feel your connection to the floor.

I invite you to bring your attention down to your feet. Notice the contact they make with the mat. Are your toes gripping, or are they relaxed? (Pause for 10 seconds.)

Slowly move your attention up to your knees and your hips. Notice if there is any tension there. Just as we must be loose to move quickly in sparring, see if you can soften those muscles while keeping your structure strong. (Pause for 10 seconds.)

Now, bring your attention to your shoulders and your jaw. Often, when we focus hard, we clench our jaw or raise our shoulders. Notice what is happening there right now. If you find tension, simply notice it, and on your next exhale, try to let it drop away. (Pause for 15 seconds.)

Feel your whole body now, from the top of your head to the soles of your feet. You are centered. You are grounded. When you are ready, slowly bring your attention back to the room and open your eyes."